THE CANADIAN MONEY STARTER KIT - 2026

Your one-page cheat sheet: 2026 limits, deadlines & beginner mistakes.

TFSA

TAX-FREE SAVINGS ACCOUNT

2026 limit:	**$7,000 / year**
Lifetime room*:	**up to $109,000**
Deadline:	**None - room carries forward**
Withdrawals:	**Tax-free, anytime**

RRSP

REGISTERED RETIREMENT SAVINGS PLAN

2026 limit:	**18% of income**
Max:	**$33,810**
Deadline:	**March 1, 2027**
Withdrawals:	**Taxed as income**

FHSA

FIRST-HOME SAVINGS ACCOUNT

Yearly limit:	**$8,000 / year**
Lifetime:	**$40,000 max**
Who:	**Ages 18-71**
Withdrawals:	**Tax-free (home)**

**If you were 18+ and a Canadian resident since 2009 and never contributed. Check CRA My Account for your exact room.*

3 BEGINNER MISTAKES TO AVOID

1. Overcontributing.

Going over your TFSA or RRSP limit triggers a 1% per month penalty on the excess. Track your room yourself - CRA's numbers can lag.

2. Day-trading inside your TFSA.

CRA can tax frequent trading as business income, wiping out the tax-free benefit. Keep it boring: buy, hold, repeat.

3. Renters ignoring the FHSA.

Even with no home in sight, the FHSA gives a tax deduction now and a tax-free withdrawal later. $8,000/year of free tax room - don't leave it on the table.